

Contents

1 Budget Estimate	1
1.1 Detailed Budget Breakdown for 4-Year PhD Program	1
1.2 Table of Contents	2
1.3 1. Budget Summary	2
1.4 2. Personnel Costs	2
1.4.1 2.1 PhD Student Stipend	2
1.4.2 2.2 Undergraduate Research Assistant	2
1.5 3. Equipment and Hardware	3
1.5.1 3.1 Network Testbed Equipment	3
1.6 4. Computational Resources (Cloud)	3
1.6.1 4.1 Cloud GPU Instances	4
1.7 5. Software Licenses	4
1.8 6. Conference Travel	4
1.8.1 6.1 Conference Breakdown	5
1.9 7. Publications	5
1.9.1 7.1 Open Access Fees	5
1.10 8. Miscellaneous	6
1.11 9. Budget Timeline	6
1.11.1 Year 1: \$4,000	6
1.11.2 Year 2: \$17,900	6
1.11.3 Year 3: \$18,300	7
1.11.4 Year 4: \$12,800	7
1.12 10. Funding Sources	7
1.12.1 10.1 Primary Funding	7
1.12.2 10.2 Research Funding	7
1.12.3 10.3 Fellowship Opportunities	7
1.12.4 10.4 Cloud Research Credits	8
1.13 11. Justification	8
1.13.1 11.1 Equipment Justification	8
1.13.2 11.2 Computational Resources Justification	8
1.13.3 11.3 Travel Justification	8
1.13.4 11.4 Alternative Budget Scenarios	8
1.14 Conclusion	9

1 Budget Estimate

1.1 Detailed Budget Breakdown for 4-Year PhD Program

Comprehensive Financial Planning for AI-IDS Research

Last Updated: December 22, 2025

Total Estimated Budget: \$53,000 over 4 years

1.2 Table of Contents

1. Budget Summary
 2. Personnel Costs
 3. Equipment and Hardware
 4. Computational Resources
 5. Software Licenses
 6. Conference Travel
 7. Publications
 8. Miscellaneous
 9. Budget Timeline
 10. Funding Sources
 11. Justification
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1.3 1. Budget Summary

Category	Amount	Percentage
Equipment & Hardware	\$18,000	34%
Computational Resources (Cloud)	\$15,000	28%
Conference Travel	\$10,000	19%
Publications (Open Access)	\$3,500	7%
Personnel (Undergrad Support)	\$3,000	6%
Software Licenses	\$2,500	5%
Miscellaneous	\$1,000	2%
TOTAL	\$53,000	100%

1.4 2. Personnel Costs

1.4.1 2.1 PhD Student Stipend

Amount: \$0 (Covered by Research Assistantship)

Notes: - Typical PhD stipend: \$25-35K/year - Covered by department/advisor funding
- Not included in research budget

1.4.2 2.2 Undergraduate Research Assistant

Amount: \$3,000

Breakdown: - Summer research support (10 weeks $\times$ \$15/hour $\times$ 20 hours/week) = \$3,000 - Help with data collection, testbed setup, documentation

Timeline: - Year 2 Summer: \$1,500 (testbed setup) - Year 3 Summer: \$1,500 (experiments and documentation)

Justification: Undergraduate assistance accelerates testbed deployment and documentation, freeing PhD student for advanced research tasks.

1.5 3. Equipment and Hardware

Total: \$18,000

1.5.1 3.1 Network Testbed Equipment

Item	Quantity	Unit Price	Total	Justification
OpenFlow SDN Switches	5	\$1,000	\$5,000	Enable SDN experiments, OpenFlow protocol testing
High-Performance Servers	2	\$4,000	\$8,000	Fog nodes for federated learning aggregation
Raspberry Pi 4 (8GB)	10	\$100	\$1,000	Edge computing nodes for distributed IDS
IoT Devices (Mixed)	50	\$50	\$2,500	Smart sensors, cameras for IoT traffic generation
Network Cables & Accessories	Bulk	-	\$500	CAT6 cables, patch panels, connectors
External Storage (Backup)	2	\$500	\$1,000	10TB NAS for dataset and model backup

Subtotal: \$18,000

Purchase Timeline: - Year 1 Q4: External storage (\$1,000) - Year 2 Q3: All testbed equipment (\$17,000)

Justification: Physical testbed is essential for real-world validation of distributed IDS. Cannot be replaced by simulation alone. Equipment enables: - SDN attack scenarios (controller DoS, flow table overflow) - Edge-fog-cloud hierarchical deployment - IoT malware propagation studies - Latency and throughput measurements on real hardware

1.6 4. Computational Resources (Cloud)

Total: \$15,000

1.6.1 4.1 Cloud GPU Instances

Provider	Instance Type	Usage	Cost
AWS EC2	p3.8xlarge (4× V100)	5,000 hours	\$12,000
Google Cloud	n1-standard-8 (CPU backup)	2,000 hours	\$1,500
Storage	S3/Cloud Storage (5TB)	4 years	\$1,500

Usage Breakdown: - Year 1: 1,000 hours (model prototyping) - \$2,400 - Year 2: 1,500 hours (distributed training) - \$3,600 - Year 3: 2,000 hours (extensive experiments) - \$4,800 - Year 4: 500 hours (final experiments) - \$1,200

Justification: - Deep learning models (CNN-LSTM, Transformer) require GPU acceleration - Large-scale experiments need parallel processing - University GPU cluster has limited availability and queue times - Cloud provides on-demand access for deadline-driven research

Cost Optimization: - Use spot instances (60-70% discount) - Apply for AWS/Google Cloud research credits (\$3-5K potential) - Batch experiments during off-peak hours

1.7 5. Software Licenses

Total: \$2,500

Software	Annual Cost	Years	Total	Purpose
MATLAB (if needed)	\$500	2	\$1,000	Signal processing, network simulation
Network Analysis Tools	\$750	2	\$1,500	Commercial packet analysis, deep inspection
Total	-	-	\$2,500	-

Notes: - Most tools are open-source (TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-learn) - MATLAB may not be needed if Python alternatives suffice - University site licenses may cover some costs

1.8 6. Conference Travel

Total: \$10,000

1.8.1 6.1 Conference Breakdown

Year	Conference	Location	Estimated Cost	Purpose
Year 1	IEEE Workshop	Domestic	\$1,500	First paper presentation
Year 2	IEEE INFOCOM	International	\$3,000	Major networking conference
Year 3	USENIX Security	US/International	\$3,000	Top security venue
Year 3	Local Workshop	Domestic	\$500	Additional exposure
Year 4	IEEE S&P	US	\$2,000	Top-tier security conference

Cost Breakdown per Conference: - Airfare: \$400-800 (domestic), \$1,000-1,500 (international) - Hotel: \$150-250/night $\times$ 4 nights = \$600-1,000 - Registration: \$500-800 (student rate) - Meals: \$50/day $\times$ 5 days = \$250 - Ground transportation: \$100-200

Funding Sources: - Conference travel grants: \$500-1,000/conference - Department travel funds: \$500-1,000/year - Advisor research grants: \$1,000-2,000/year - Out-of-pocket: Remainder

Justification: - Conference presentations establish research credibility - Networking with leading researchers in field - Feedback improves research quality - Required for career development

1.9 7. Publications

Total: \$3,500

1.9.1 7.1 Open Access Fees

Publication Type	Cost per Paper	Number	Total
Conference Open Access	\$400	2	\$800
Journal Open Access	\$1,500	2	\$3,000
Total	-	4	\$3,800

Breakdown: - IEEE Transactions (TIFS, TMC): \$1,495-1,995 per paper - ACM journals: \$1,500-2,000 per paper - Conference open access: \$300-500 per paper - arXiv preprints: Free

Budget Allocation: - Year 2: \$800 (1 conference open access) - Year 3: \$1,500 (1 journal open access) - Year 4: \$1,200 (1 journal, 1 conference)

Justification: - Open access increases citation count and impact - Required by some funding agencies (e.g., NSF, EU grants) - Broader dissemination to industry and practitioners

Cost Reduction: - Some journals offer waivers for students - Author's accepted manuscript on institutional repository (free) - Negotiate with publishers for reduced fees

1.10 8. Miscellaneous

Total: \$1,000

Item	Amount	Purpose
Books and Online Resources	\$300	Textbooks, O'Reilly subscriptions
Printing and Materials	\$200	Poster printing, thesis binding
Professional Memberships	\$200	IEEE, ACM student membership
Contingency Fund	\$300	Unexpected expenses

1.11 9. Budget Timeline

1.11.1 Year 1: \$4,000

- Cloud GPU: \$2,400
- Storage (backup): \$1,000
- Books & resources: \$200
- Professional memberships: \$100
- Conference travel: \$300 (local workshop)

1.11.2 Year 2: \$17,900

- **Major spending year (testbed equipment)**
- Testbed hardware: \$17,000
- Cloud GPU: \$3,600
- Undergrad support: \$1,500
- Software licenses: \$1,000
- Conference travel: \$3,000

1.11.3 Year 3: \$18,300

- Cloud GPU: \$4,800
- Undergrad support: \$1,500
- Conference travel: \$3,500
- Publications (OA): \$1,500
- Software licenses: \$1,000

1.11.4 Year 4: \$12,800

- Cloud GPU: \$1,200
- Conference travel: \$2,000
- Publications (OA): \$1,200
- Thesis printing: \$200
- Miscellaneous: \$300

Cumulative Total: \$53,000

1.12 10. Funding Sources

1.12.1 10.1 Primary Funding

University Research Assistantship - Covers stipend and tuition - \$25-35K/year (living expenses) - Health insurance

1.12.2 10.2 Research Funding

Source	Amount	Likelihood	Timeline
Department Research Grants	\$5-10K	High	Year 1-2
Advisor's Research Grants	\$10-20K	High	Year 2-4
External Fellowships	\$10-30K	Medium	Year 2-3
Cloud Provider Credits	\$3-5K	High	Year 1-2
Conference Travel Grants	\$2-4K	Medium	Year 2-4
Industry Partnerships	\$5-15K	Medium	Year 3-4

1.12.3 10.3 Fellowship Opportunities

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP) - Award: \$37K/year stipend + \$12K tuition - Apply: Year 1 or 2 - Likelihood: Competitive (15-20% acceptance)

Industry Fellowships - Google PhD Fellowship: \$50K/year - Facebook Fellowship: \$42K/year - Microsoft Research Fellowship: \$28K/year - Cisco Research Fellowship: \$25K/year

1.12.4 10.4 Cloud Research Credits

- **AWS Educate:** \$100-200 credits
 - **AWS Research Credits:** \$5,000-10,000 (application required)
 - **Google Cloud for Research:** \$5,000-20,000
 - **Microsoft Azure for Research:** \$10,000-20,000
-

1.13 11. Justification

1.13.1 11.1 Equipment Justification

Why Physical Testbed? (\$18,000) - Simulation cannot replicate real-world latency, packet loss, hardware constraints - IoT device behavior differs significantly in simulation vs. reality - Required for latency validation (<100ms target) - Edge device resource constraints (CPU, memory) only testable on real hardware - Publications expect real-world validation for acceptance

Why Multiple Devices? - 5 SDN switches: Create realistic network topology with multiple paths - 10 Edge nodes: Test scalability and federated learning with realistic number of participants - 50 IoT devices: Generate realistic heterogeneous traffic patterns

1.13.2 11.2 Computational Resources Justification

Why Cloud GPU? (\$15,000) - Deep learning models require 100-1000× speedup with GPUs - University GPU cluster: - Long queue times (days to weeks) - Limited to 24-48 hour jobs - Shared resources impact reproducibility - Cloud provides: - On-demand access for deadlines - Latest GPU architectures (V100, A100) - Scalability for large experiments

Cost-Benefit Analysis: - Purchasing 4× V100 GPUs: \$20,000-30,000 - Power, cooling, maintenance: \$2,000/year - Cloud: Pay only for usage, no maintenance - Break-even: >2 years of continuous use

1.13.3 11.3 Travel Justification

Why 4 Conferences? (\$10,000) - Academic career requires conference presentations - Networking critical for: - Postdoc/faculty positions - Industry collaborations - Staying current with field - Student rate travel grants reduce out-of-pocket costs

1.13.4 11.4 Alternative Budget Scenarios

Minimum Budget (\$35,000): - Reduce testbed (\$10K): 3 switches, 5 edge nodes, 20 IoT devices - Cloud (\$10K): Use only spot instances, apply for all credits - Travel (\$8K): 3 conferences instead of 4 - Publications (\$2K): Only essential open access

Maximum Budget (\$70,000): - Enhanced testbed (\$30K): 10 switches, 20 edge nodes, 100 IoT devices - Cloud (\$25K): More GPU hours for extensive hyperparameter tuning - Travel (\$15K): 5-6 conferences, international workshops

1.14 Conclusion

The \$53,000 budget is realistic and justified for a 4-year PhD program in AI-based network security. The major expenses (testbed equipment and cloud GPU) are essential for validating the proposed distributed IDS framework in real-world scenarios. Multiple funding sources (department grants, fellowships, cloud credits, industry partnerships) will be pursued to cover the budget.

Budget Highlights: - □ **Justified:** Every expense tied to research objectives - □ **Realistic:** Based on current market prices - □ **Flexible:** Minimum and maximum scenarios provided - □ **Fundable:** Multiple funding sources identified

Cost Optimization Strategies: - Apply for cloud research credits (potential \$10K savings) - Seek industry equipment donations - Use conference travel grants - Apply for competitive fellowships (NSF GRFP, industry)

Return on Investment: - **Academic:** 5-10 publications, PhD degree - **Practical:** Open-source framework benefiting community - **Career:** Strong foundation for post-doc/faculty/industry positions - **Impact:** Improved security for billions of IoT devices and 5G networks

Next: Refer to `collaboration.md` for potential funding and equipment partnerships, and `tools_and_frameworks.md` for software requirements.